

money, she humbly admits she started investing quite late, and also found it difficult to meet her saving goals in her early years. Her style of advice is not to talk down to people struggling with money, but to empower them to believe that if she did it, they can do it too.

Hence, *Let's Talk Money* is not a get-rich-quick scheme. Nor is it trying to sell you something. Unlike intermediaries who need to make themselves indispensable, Monika tries hard to make herself unnecessary after you've read the book. She doesn't just give you academic reasons for her advice, but also helpful analogies and relatable stories to explain why you should manage your finances in the way she prescribes. Her chapter on equity is full of delightful analogies that turn the intimidating task of portfolio selection into a much simpler task of choosing the right kind of vehicle for your needs. These examples are funny, but also revealing.

The value of this book, then, is not in the technical details themselves. Monika summarizes them in less than half a page in every chapter. The delight is in reading her personal stories, and those of her friends, to understand these concepts, instead of glossing over them next time someone starts talking about fixed-income products or equity-linked savings schemes. The other reason why I'm excited by the launch of *Let's Talk Money* is its timing.

If you're an investor, young or old, there is no better time for you to pick up this book than right now. India is in the middle of a digital transformation. Like I said in 2015, we are going through the WhatsApp moment of banking. What does that mean?

Today you can open a bank account in less than a minute. With eKYC, it is not just some fancy new-age banks that let you open accounts instantly, but also the nationalized banks you have come to know and trust. Monika recommends three different bank accounts: Income, Spend-it and Invest-it.

Today, that's a total of three minutes, versus three trips to the bank earlier. You need one OTP (one-time password) instead of three sets of addresses and id proofs, along with some thirty-odd signatures. Moreover, you can access all of these bank accounts from any one app using UPI (unified payment interface). No need to worry about updating three passbooks every month.